

— SPM 381 — CONSUMER BEHAVIOR IN SPORT

Sports and Social Media I

Arcadia University Sport Management · Week 2, Part 1

Before We Begin

What is social media to you?

How did social media change your life?

The False Self on Social Media

- *Social Media Friendship— Real vs. Virtual??*
- *What's on your mind?*
- Watch Video Clips (below): <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=QxVZYiJK11Y>



Video – click the link above to watch

Social Media Quick Facts

5.79B

people now use social media worldwide

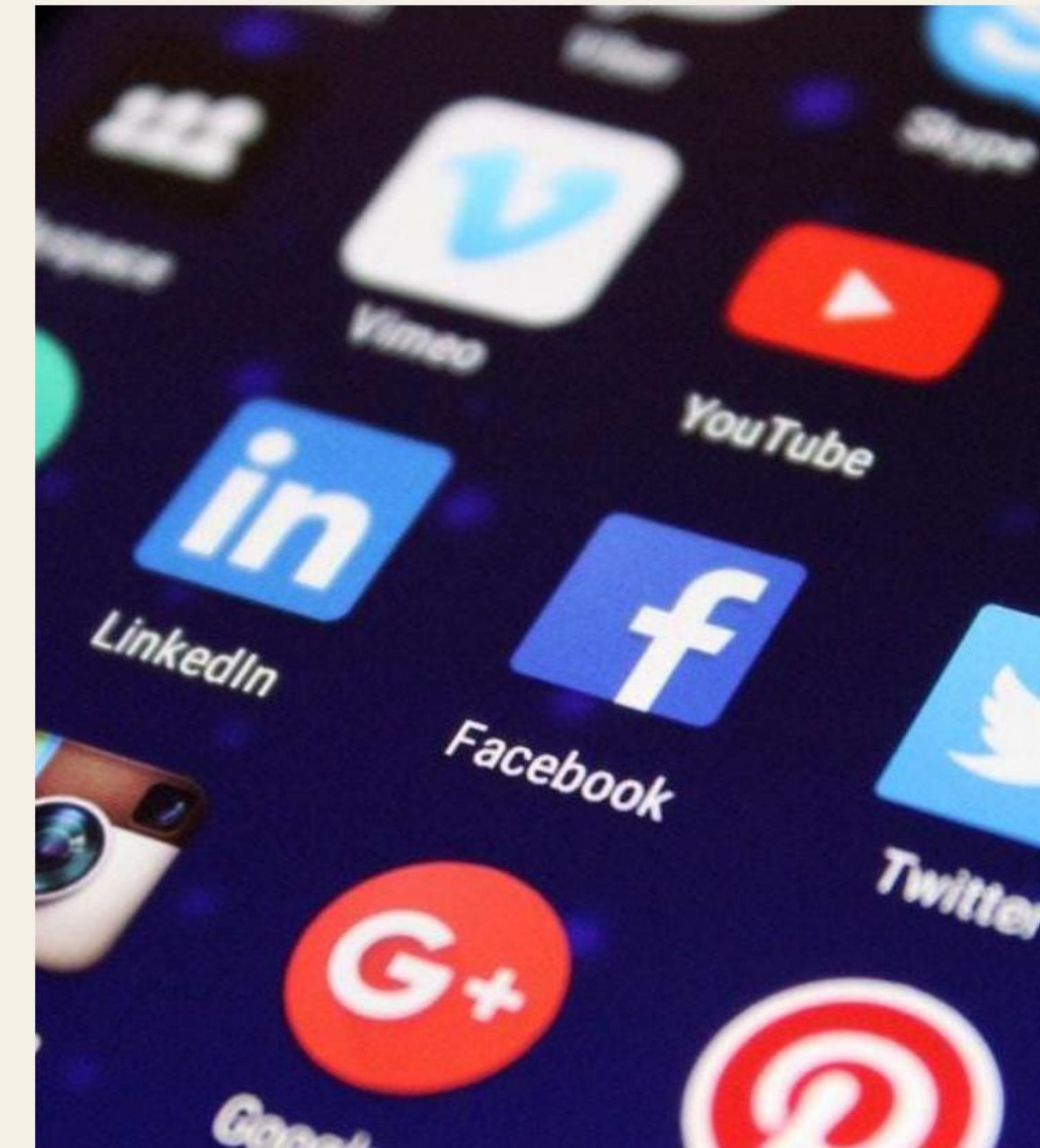
3.56B

Meta daily active people across apps, Q1 2026

59%

of marketers rank brand awareness their #1 goal

- 5.79 billion people now use social media worldwide, more than two-thirds of everyone on Earth
- Meta's daily active people across Facebook, Instagram, Messenger and WhatsApp hit 3.56 billion in Q1 2026
- Meta's advertising-driven revenue hit \$56.31 billion in Q1 2026, up 33% year-over-year
- Brand awareness is now the #1 goal for 59% of social media marketers, more than double the 29% who ranked it first in 2025
- Social media in 2026 is less about driving immediate sales than influencing the decisions that happen afterward. People increasingly discover brands, products and creators on social platforms before researching, comparing and purchasing elsewhere



Social Media Quick Facts, cont.

8M+

advertisers use Meta's AI ad creative tools

17%

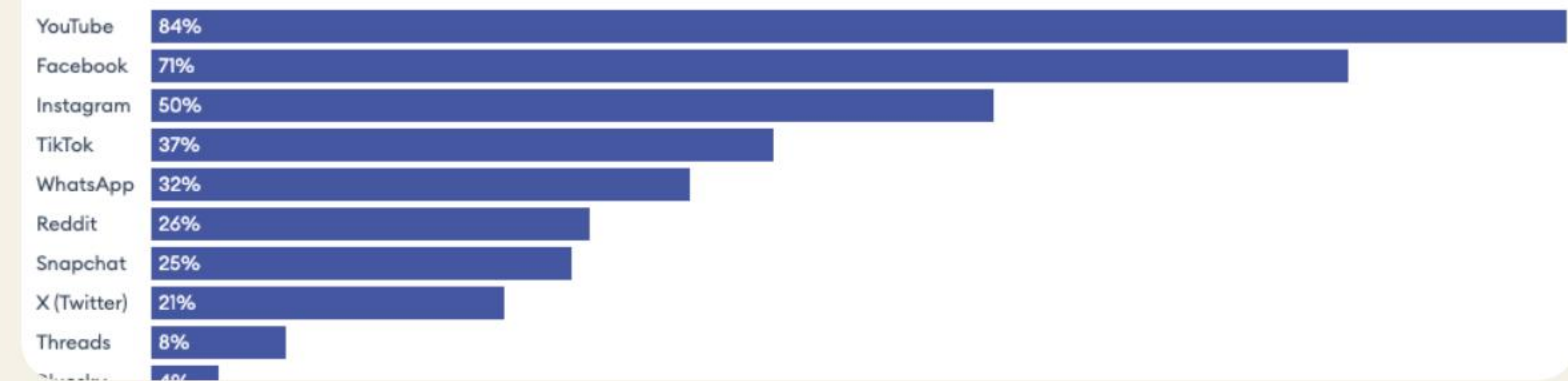
YoY growth in Reddit daily active users

84%

of shoppers feel more confident after researching on Reddit

- More than 8 million advertisers now use at least one of Meta's AI ad creative tools, with especially strong adoption among small and medium-sized businesses
- Reddit's daily active user base grew 17% year-over-year to 126.8 million in Q1 2026
- 84% of shoppers say they feel more confident in their purchase decisions after researching on Reddit
- LinkedIn may have lower overall marketer adoption than Instagram or Facebook, but it remains the most-used B2B platform

Top Social Media Platforms in 2026



Perception of Social Media

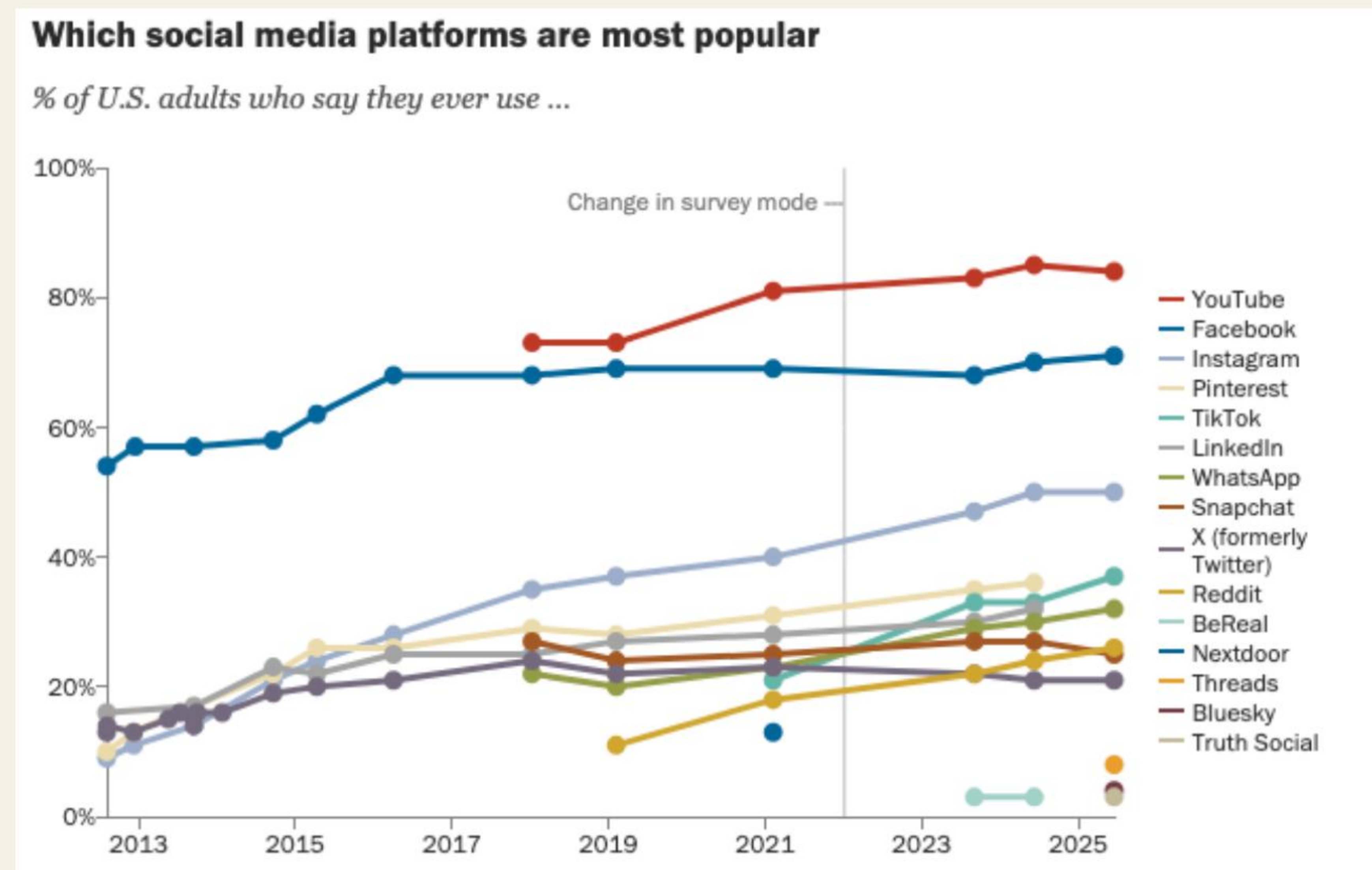
- Trendy / Passing Fad
- Marketing Platform
- Now, an integral part of life

Social Media: Then and Now



Source – mediabistro.com/alltwitter/social-media-then-now_b59744

Social Media Fact Sheet



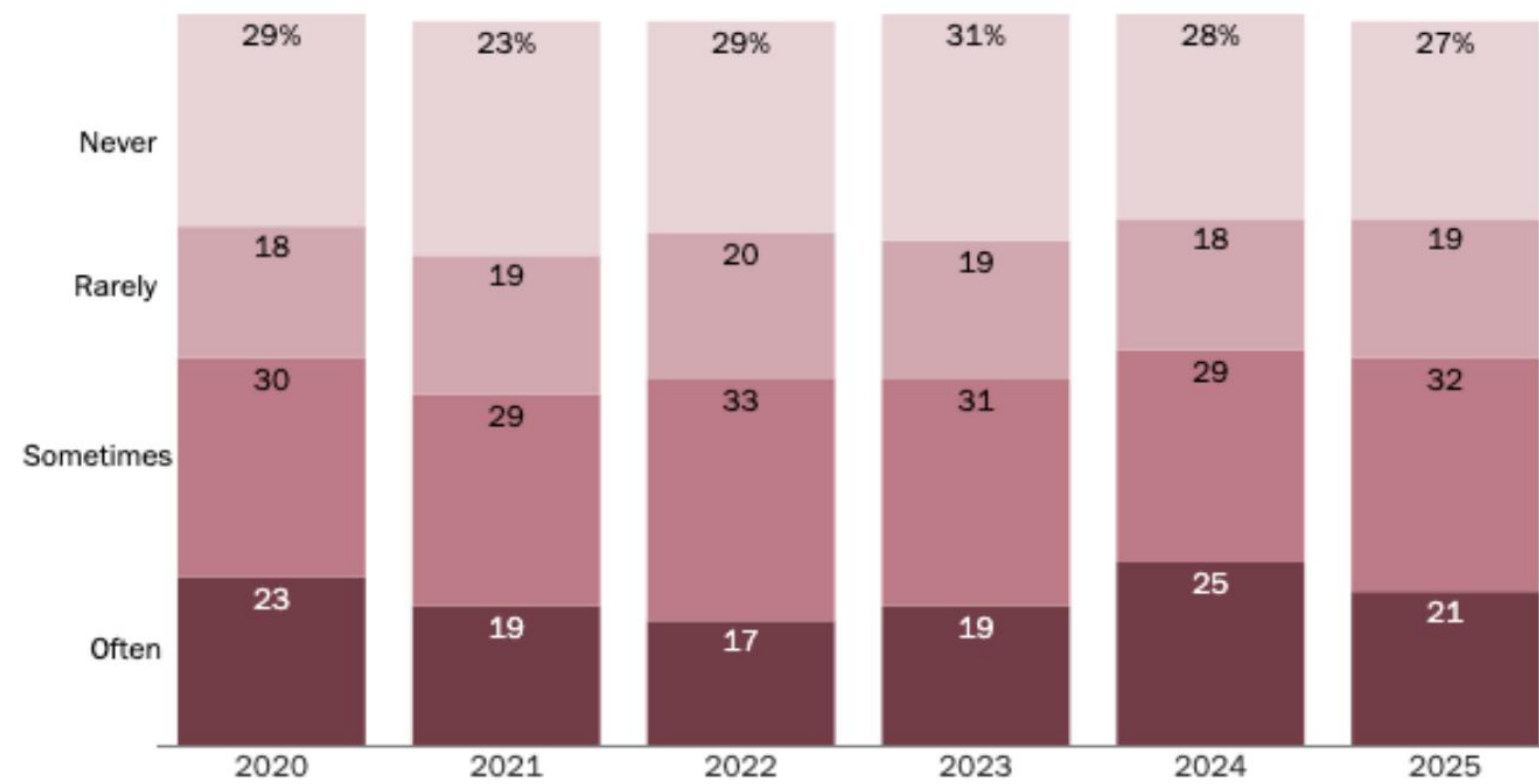
Source – [pewresearch.org/internet/fact-sheet/social-media/](https://www.pewresearch.org/internet/fact-sheet/social-media/)

Who Uses Each Social Media Platform?

AGE	RACE &		HOUSEHOLD		
	GENDER	ETHNICITY	INCOME	EDUCATION	COMMUNITY
	Ages 18-29		30-49	50-64	65+
YouTube	95		92	85	64
Facebook	68		80	74	57
Instagram	80		62	40	19
TikTok	63		44	30	12
WhatsApp	37		40	30	20
Reddit	48		35	16	6
Snapchat	58		31	13	4
X (formerly Twitter)	33		25	16	10
Threads	15		10	6	3
Bluesky	6		5	3	2
Truth Social	1		3	5	4

News consumption on social media

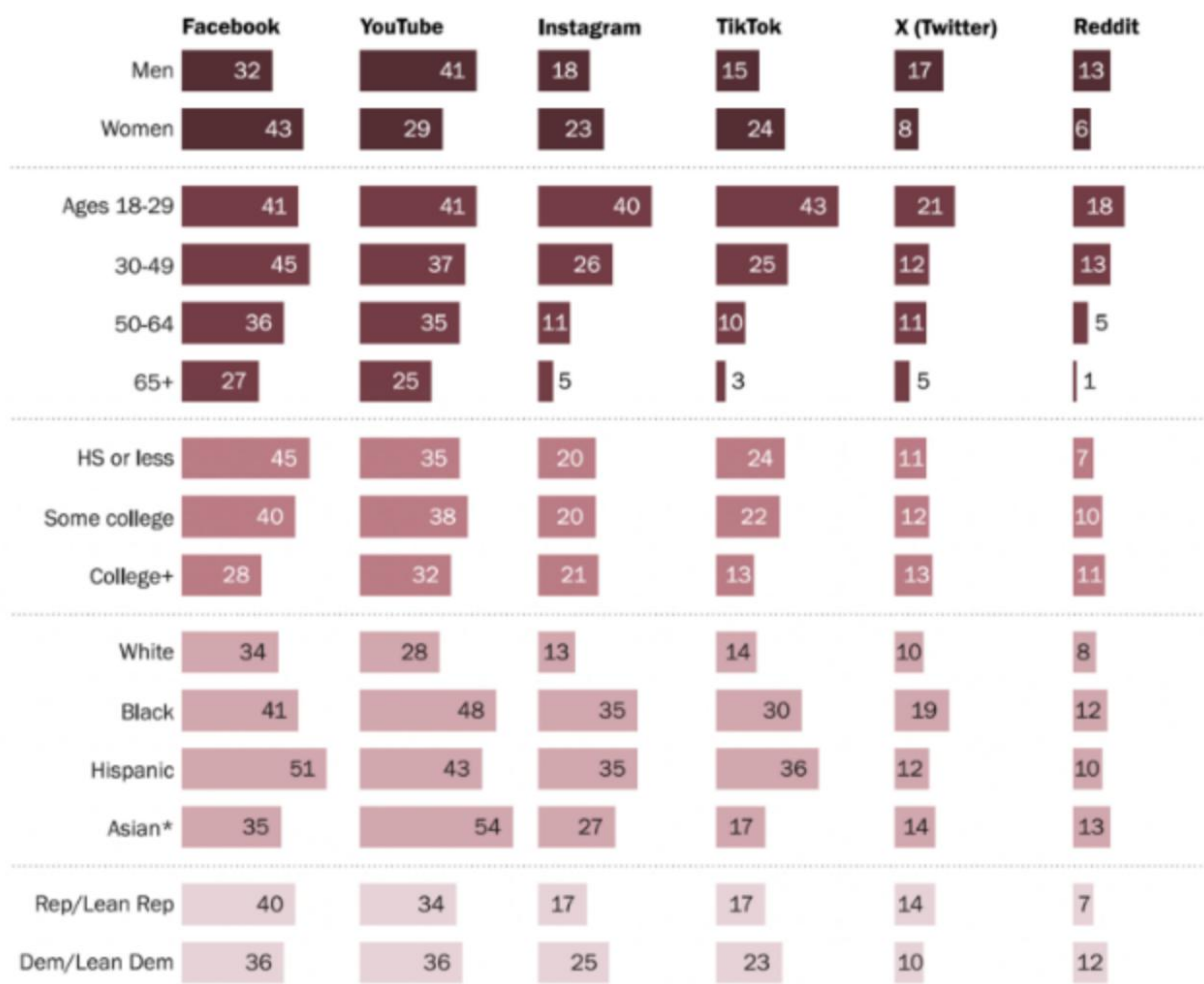
% of U.S. adults who say they get news from social media ...



Source – [pewresearch.org/journalism/fact-sheet/social-media-and-news-fact-sheet/](https://www.pewresearch.org/journalism/fact-sheet/social-media-and-news-fact-sheet/)

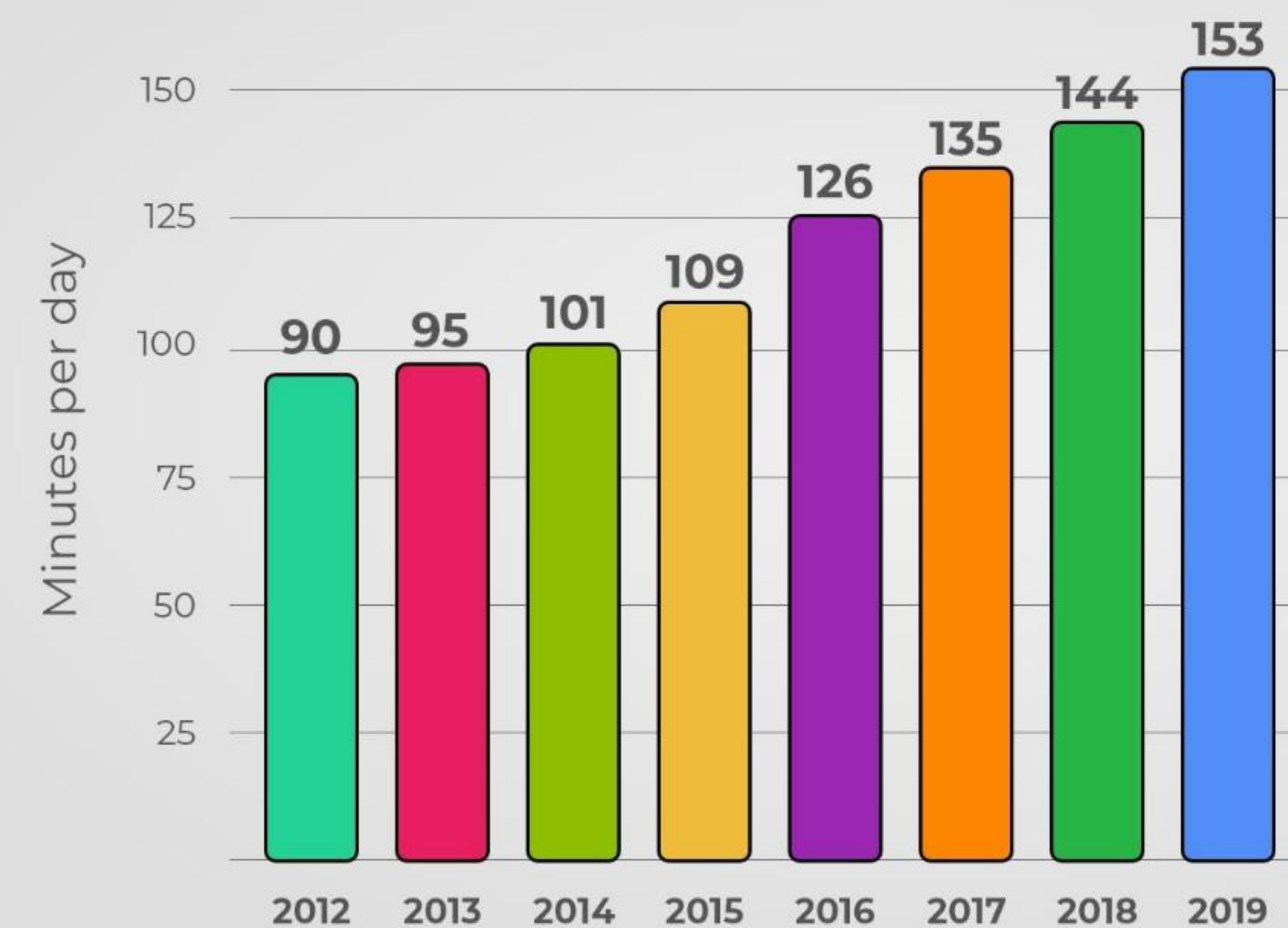
Demographics and party identification of regular social media news consumers in the U.S.

% of U.S. adults who say they *regularly* get news from each social media site



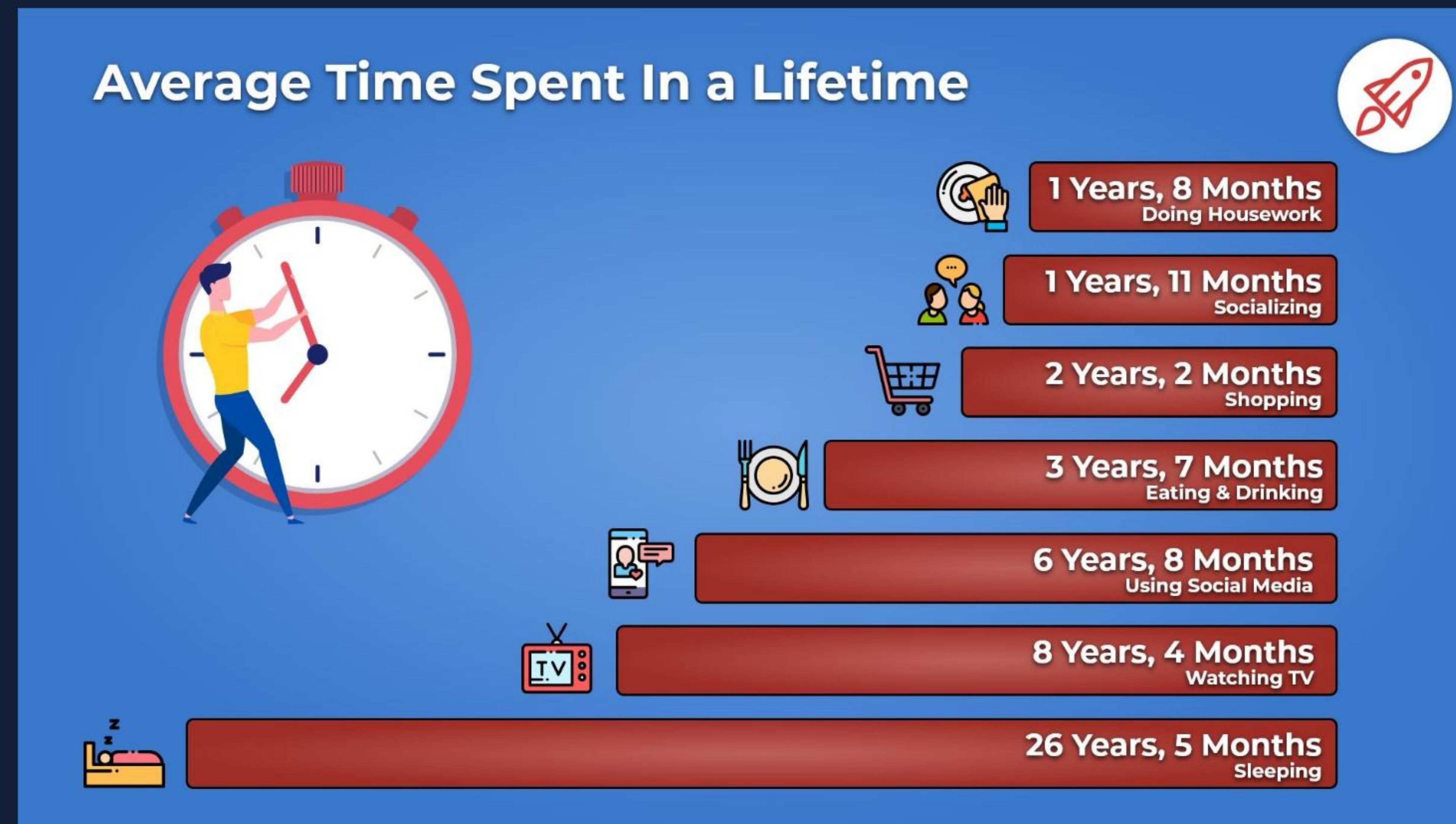
The Growing Impact of Social Media

Daily Time Spent On Social Networking
2012-2019 (in minutes)



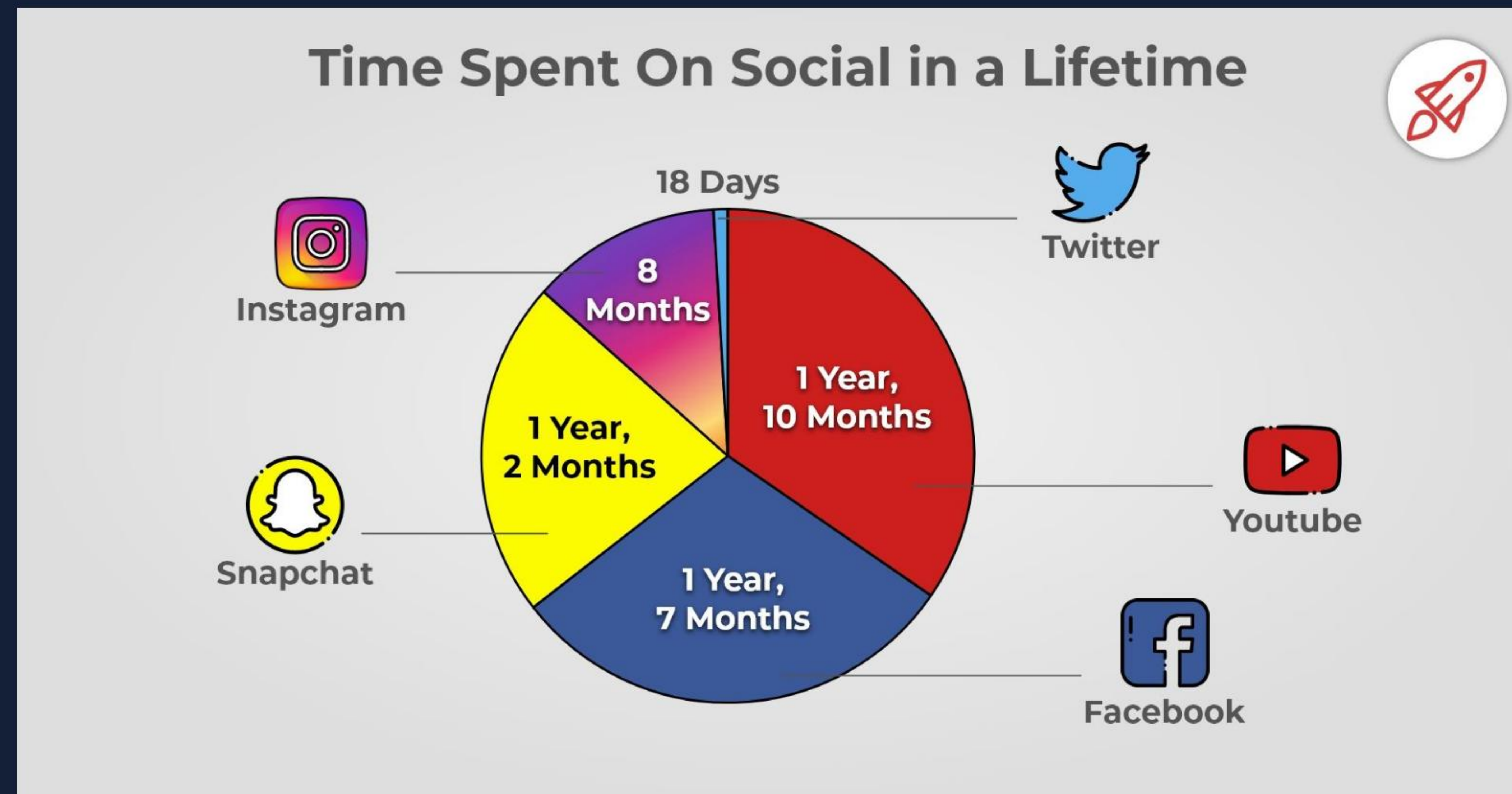
Source – broadbandsearch.net/blog/average-daily-time-on-social-media

The Growing Impact of Social Media, cont.



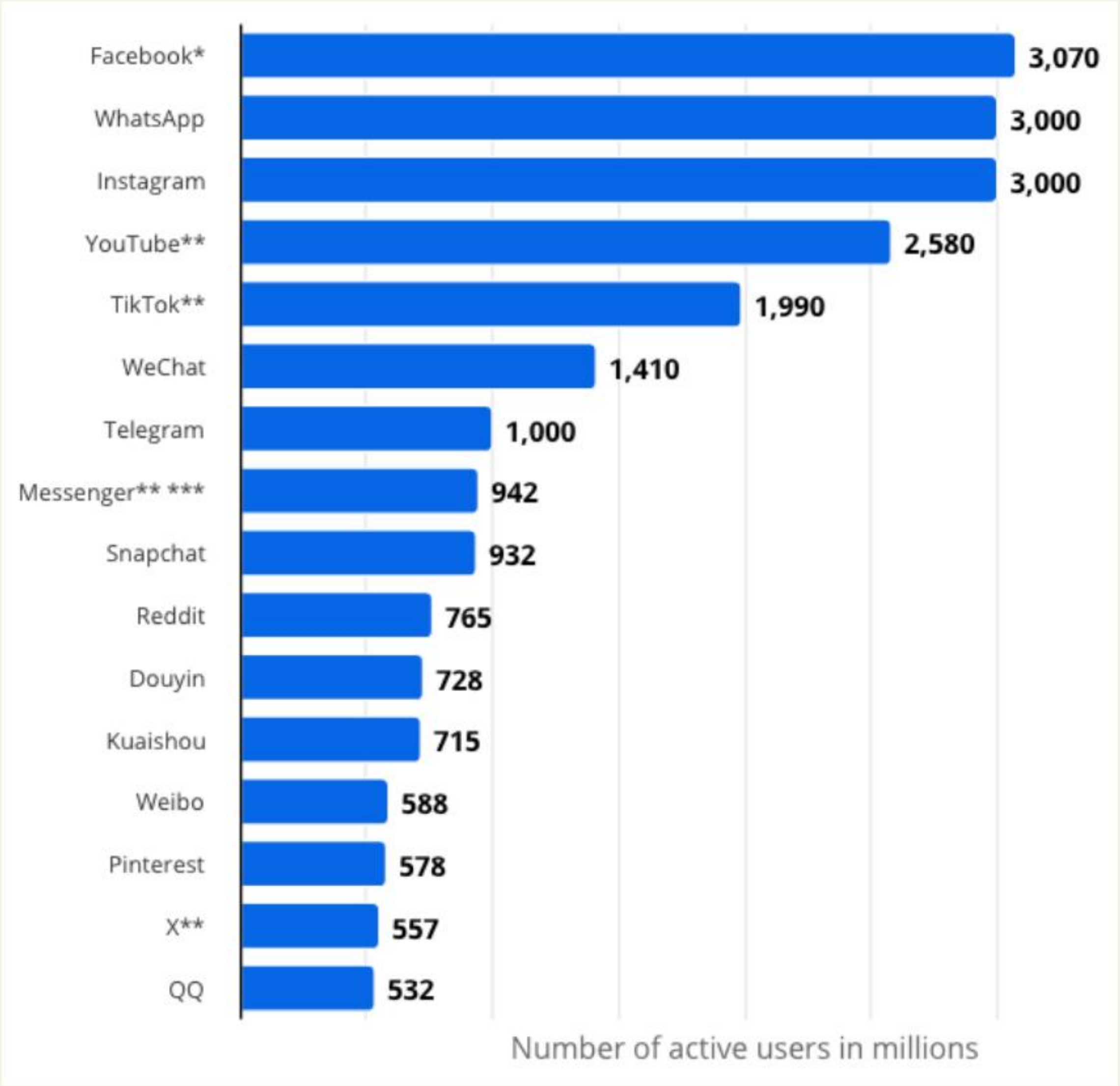
Source – broadbandsearch.net/blog/average-daily-time-on-social-media

The Growing Impact of Social Media, cont.



Source – broadbandsearch.net/blog/average-daily-time-on-social-media

Most Popular Social Networks Worldwide, as of Oct 2025

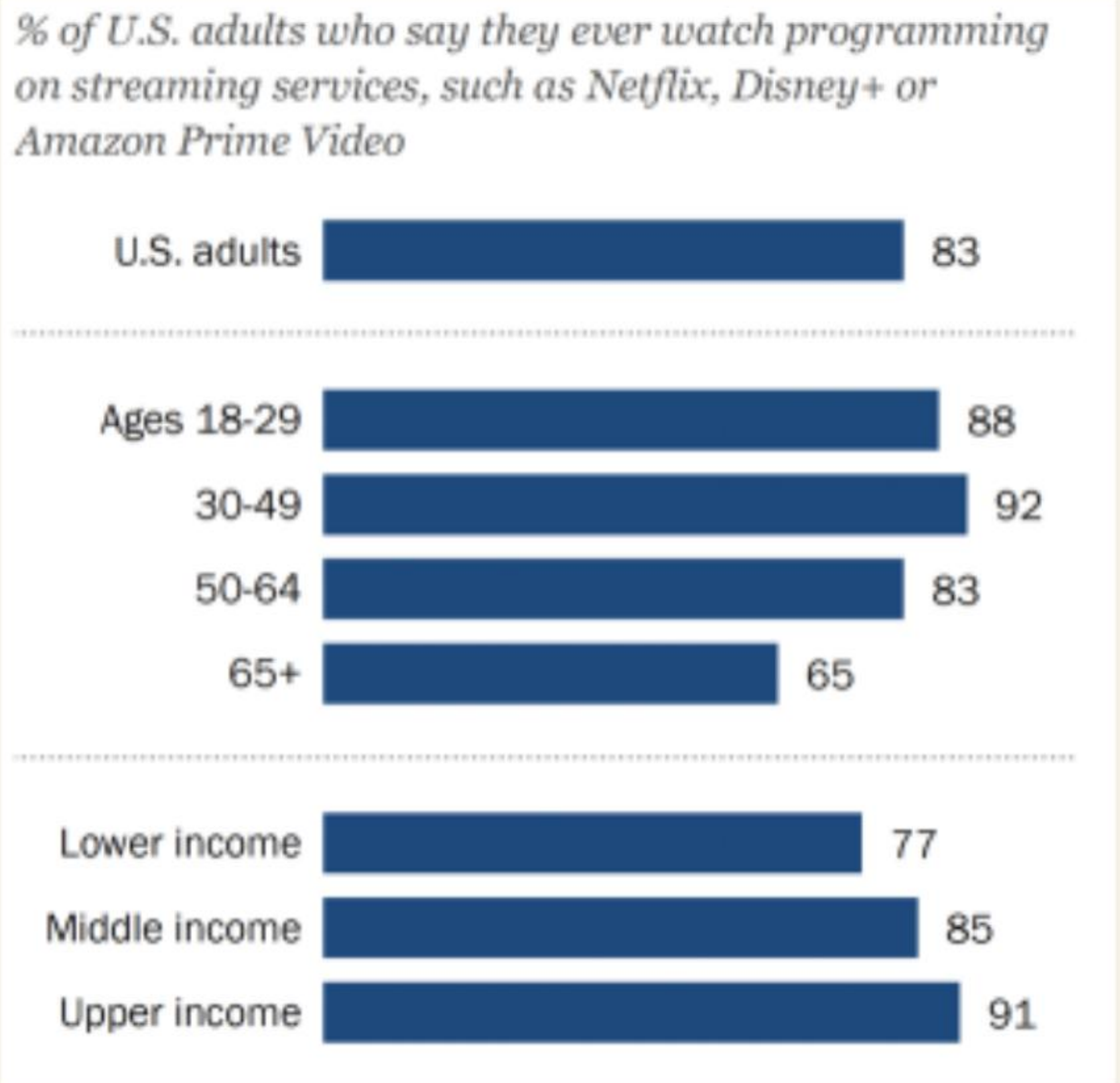


Source – [statista.com/statistics/272014/global-social-networks-ranked-by-number-of-users/?srsltid=AfmB0oq4y_f6MQvDI6_FM9fsFP6d3noFo9032WAMNgkvESaHj9l8uc1T](https://www.statista.com/statistics/272014/global-social-networks-ranked-by-number-of-users/?srsltid=AfmB0oq4y_f6MQvDI6_FM9fsFP6d3noFo9032WAMNgkvESaHj9l8uc1T)

83% of U.S. Adults Use Streaming Services, Far Fewer Subscribe to Cable or Satellite TV



Most Americans Use Streaming Services, Including Majorities Across Age and Income Groups

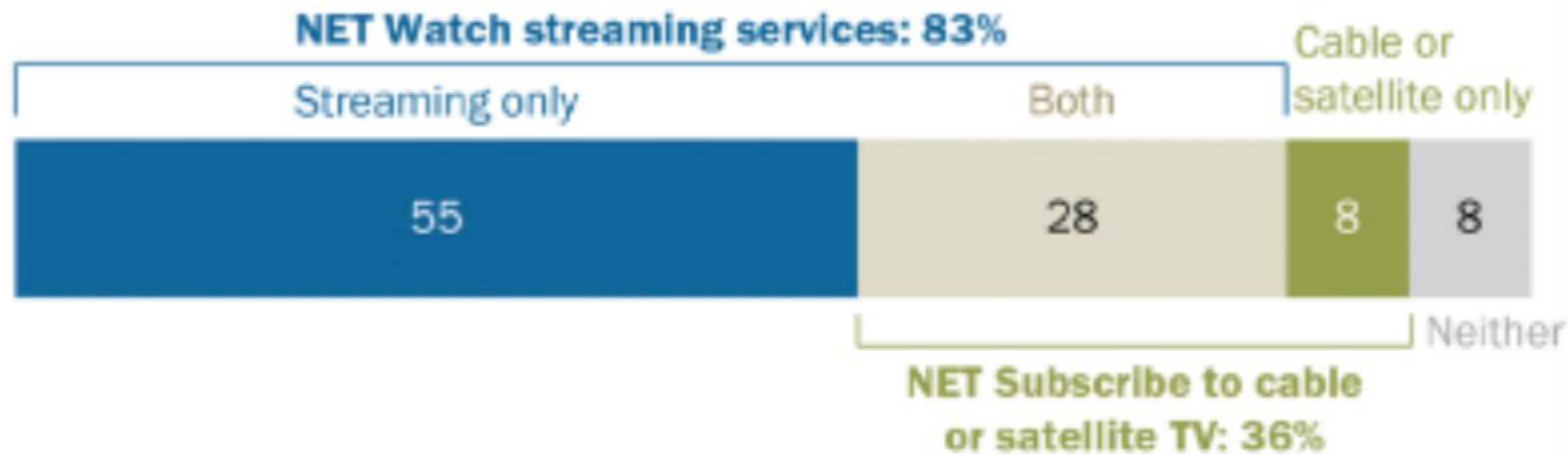


Source – [pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/07/01/83-of-us-adults-use-streaming-services-far-fewer-subscribe-to-cable-or-satellite-tv/](https://www.pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/07/01/83-of-us-adults-use-streaming-services-far-fewer-subscribe-to-cable-or-satellite-tv/)

Streaming Services, cont.

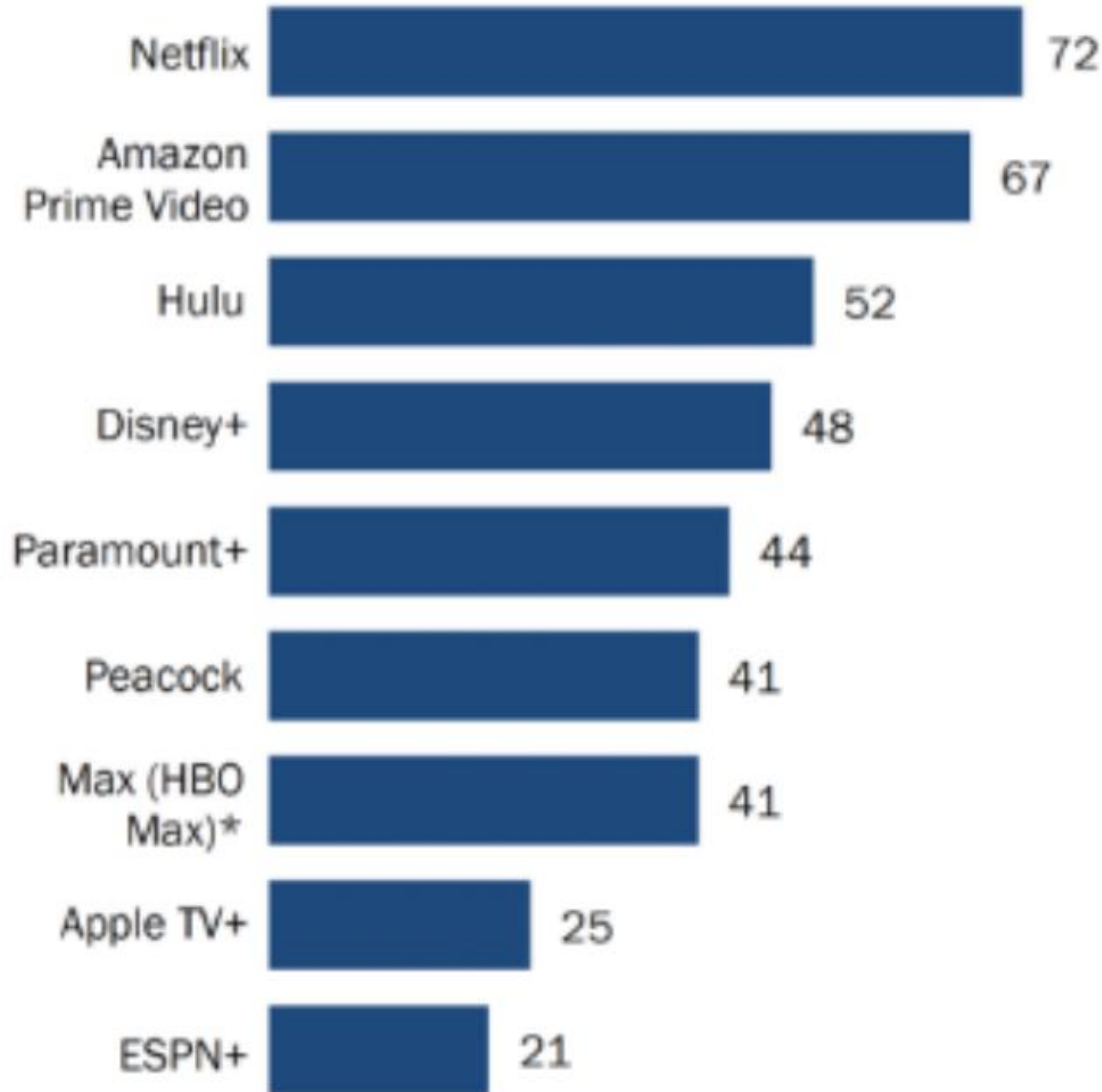
Just over half of Americans watch streaming services but do not subscribe to cable or satellite TV

% of U.S. adults who say they ...



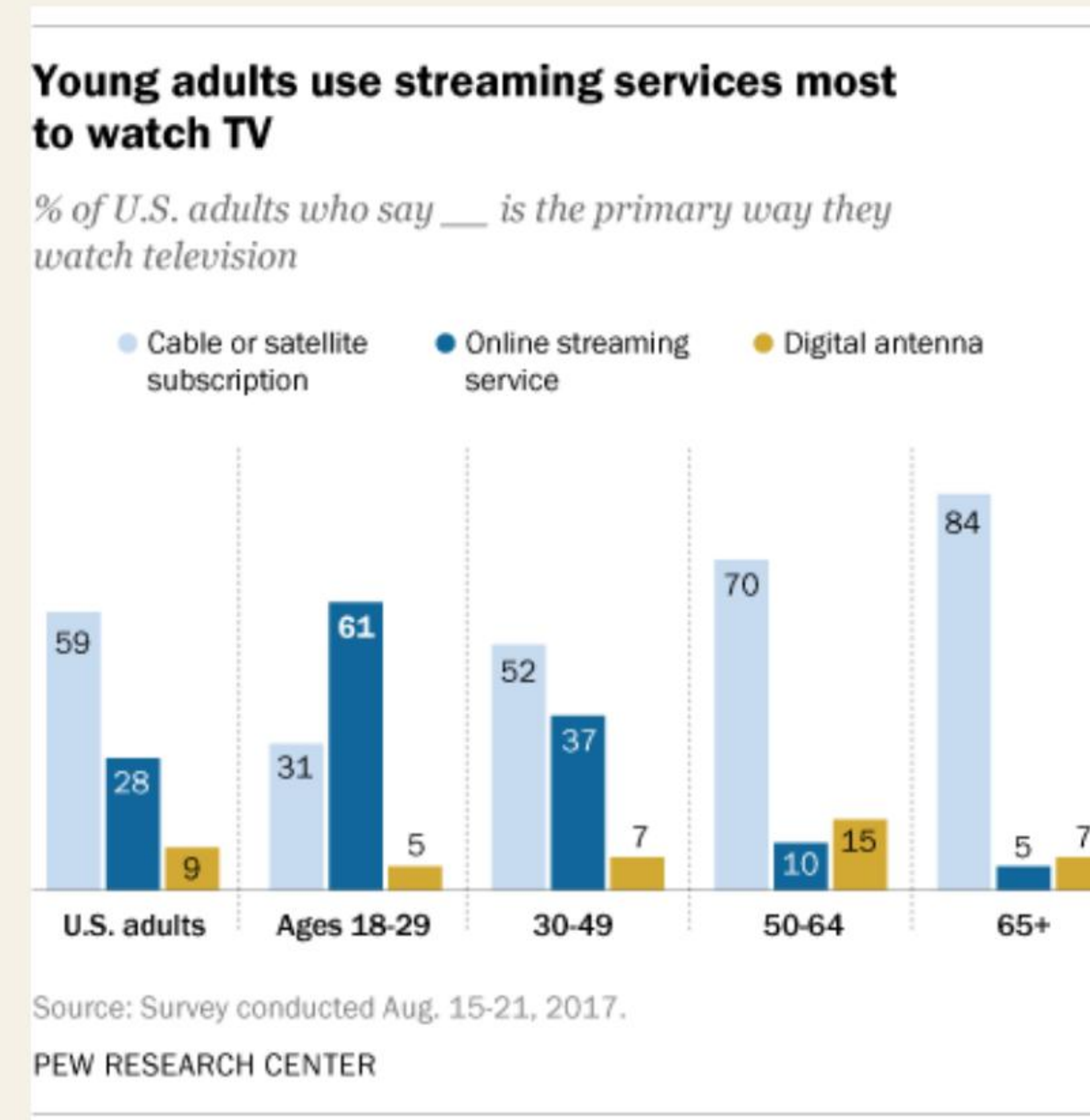
Majorities of Americans watch Netflix, Amazon Prime Video

% of U.S. adults who say they ever watch programming on ...



Source – [pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/07/01/83-of-us-adults-use-streaming-services-far-fewer-subscribe-to-cable-or-satellite-tv/](https://www.pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/07/01/83-of-us-adults-use-streaming-services-far-fewer-subscribe-to-cable-or-satellite-tv/)

About 6 in 10 Young Adults in U.S. Primarily Use Online Streaming to Watch TV



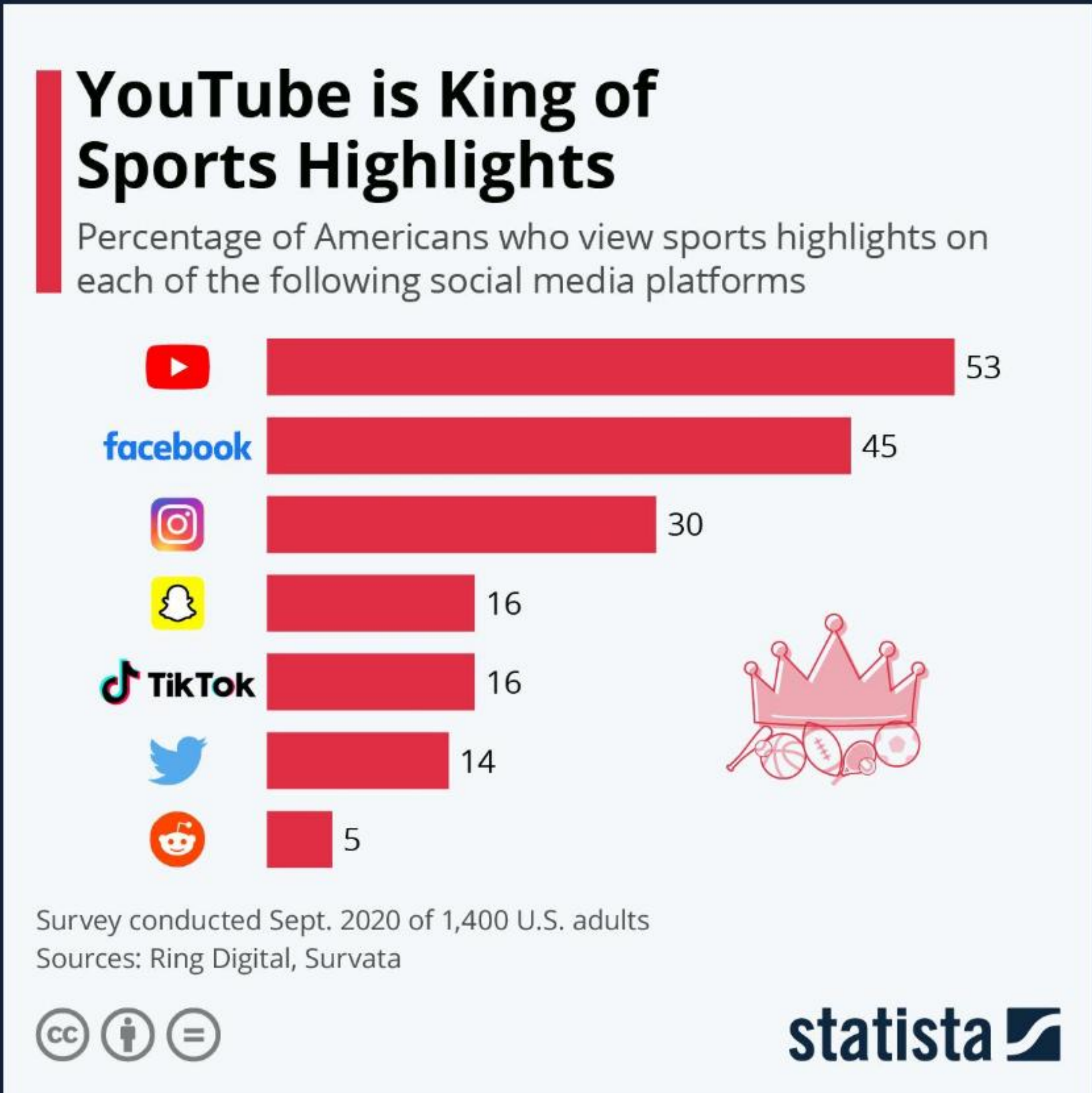
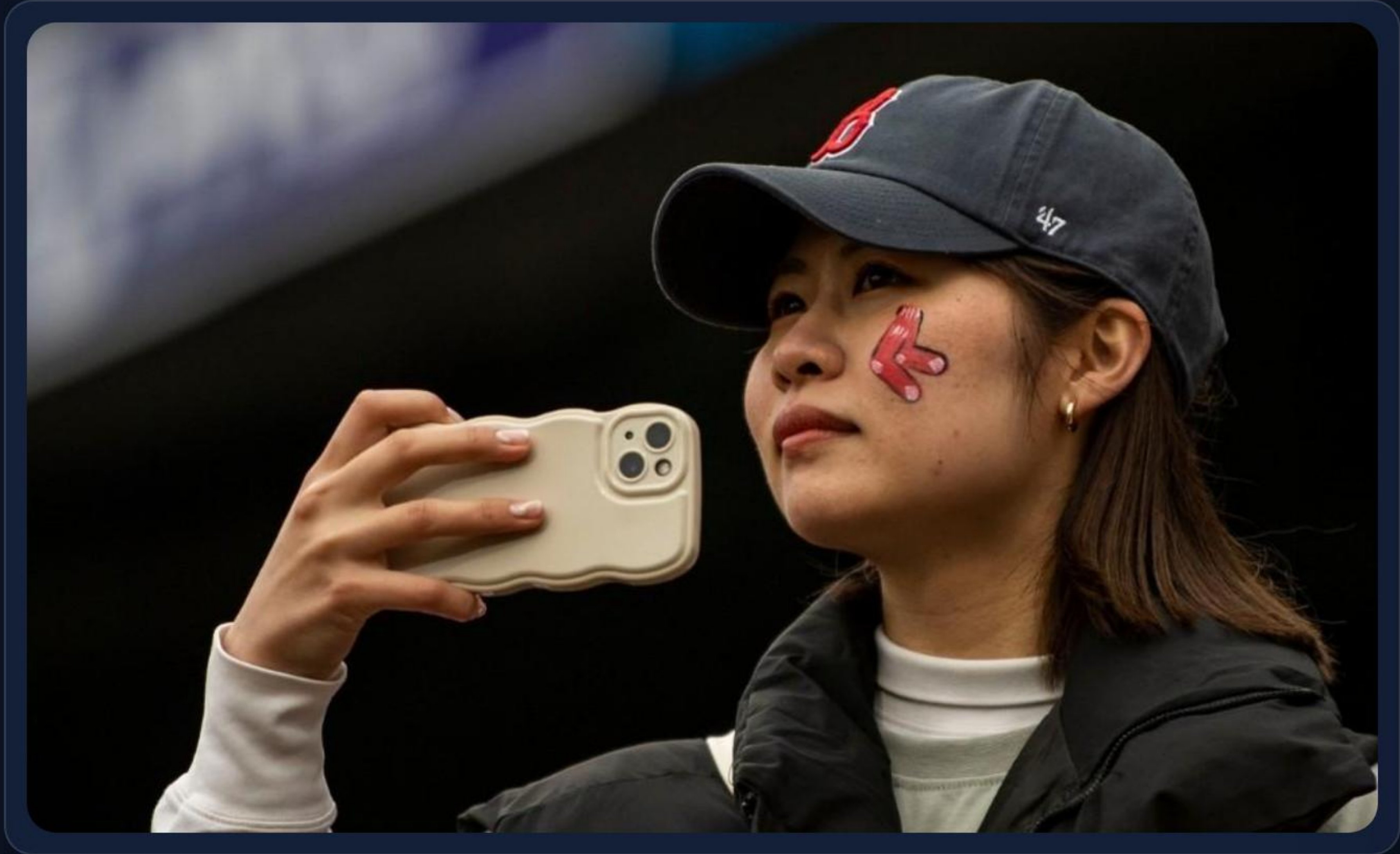
Source – [pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/07/01/83-of-us-adults-use-streaming-services-far-fewer-subscribe-to-cable-or-satellite-tv/](https://www.pewresearch.org/short-reads/2025/07/01/83-of-us-adults-use-streaming-services-far-fewer-subscribe-to-cable-or-satellite-tv/)

— SPORTS & SOCIAL MEDIA

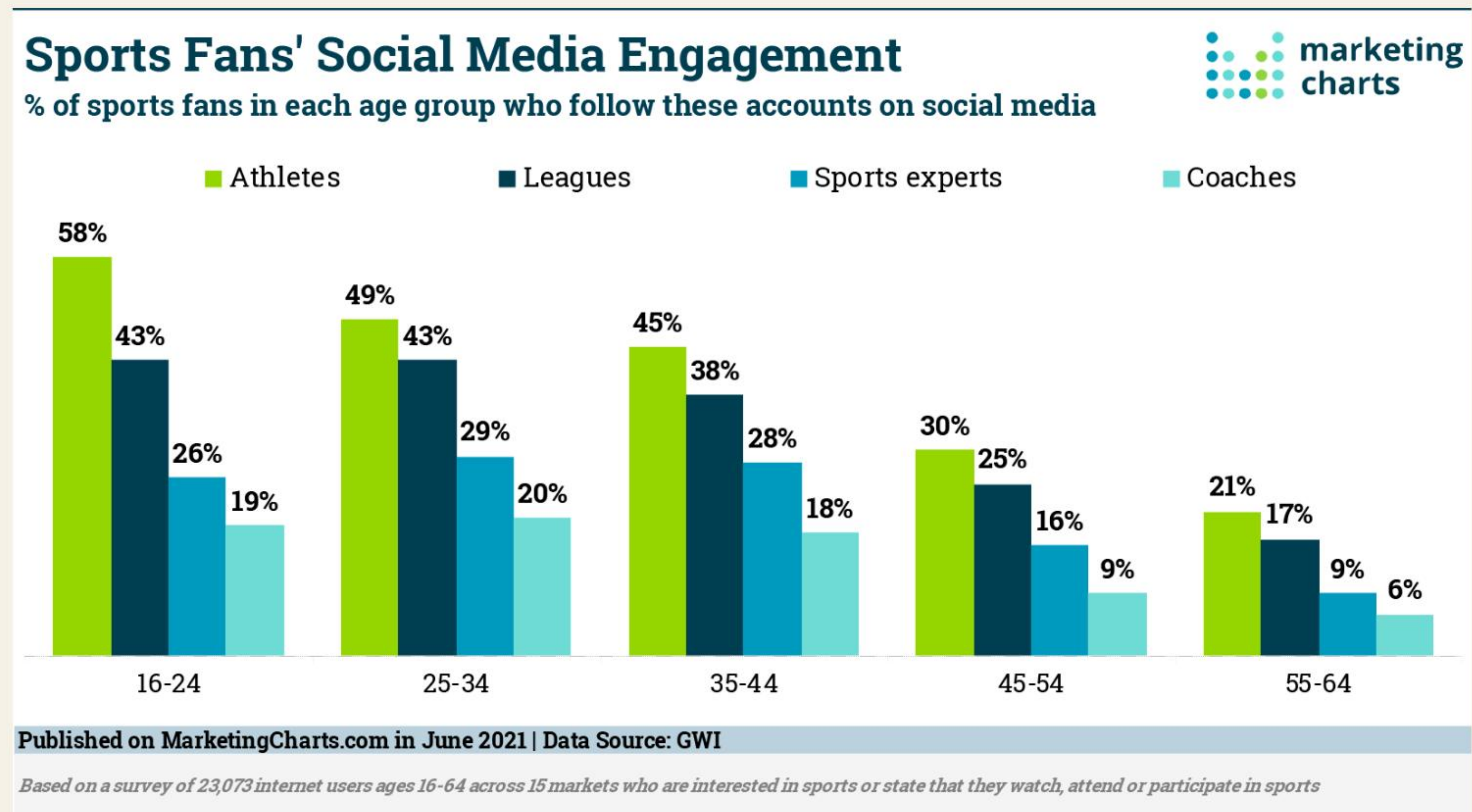
How Sports Fans Engage with Social Media?



How Sports Fans Engage with Social Media, cont.



How Sports Fans Engage with Social Media, cont.



Source – marketingcharts.com/industries/sports-industries-117340

How Did Athletes and Fans Connect?

How did athletes and fans connect before social media?

Athletes



Press

NBA, NFL, MLB,
NHL

Brands/
Advertisers

Agent

Fans



Old Days...

BOSTON Herald.com			Nutritious meets delicious	
		Rollover For Coupon		
Home	News & Opinion	Sports	Entertainment	Business
Inside Track	Blogs	Photos & Video	Obituaries	
Red Sox & MLB	Patriots & NFL	Celtics & NBA	Bruins & NHL	College
Columnists	Revolution & Soccer	Golf	High School	

[Log in](#) | [Register](#) Sun, January 30, 2011 28° F | [Traffic](#) Follow Us SEARCH:

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Shaquille O'Neal returns to LA in colors of enemy

By Mark Murphy
Sunday, January 30, 2011 - Updated 5 minutes ago
[+ Recent Articles](#) [+ Recent Blog Entries](#) [+ Email](#)

E-mail
 Print
 (5) Comments
 A Text size
 Share
 Buzz up!

LOS ANGELES — Since the day he left and burned most of the remaining goodwill on his old Lakers team, Shaquille O'Neal has returned to the site of his greatest triumphs in an ever-changing look.

He's been a member of the Heat, Suns and Cavaliers. Today, he changes for the fourth time in his post-Lakers career, now as a Celtic. That image has to vex any Lakers fan who grew up like [Paul Pierce \[stats\]](#), living from one playoff series to the next between these two teams.

Photo by AP file

TWO FOR THE AGES: Kobe Bryant and Shaquille O'Neal celebrate a Lakers victory during the 2001 season.



Kobe Bryant's Basketball Camp



Athlete–Fan Connection: A Collage



The connection was controlled, filtered, and temporal.

How Do Athletes and Fans Connect Now?

How do athletes and fans connect now using social media?

Athletes



Social media is not replacing traditional media, but rather balancing it! (Richard Ting)

Press

NBA, NFL, MLB, NHL

Brands/
Advertisers

Agent

Social Media

Fans



The new relationship model is a **dialogue**



Not a **monologue**



A Review of Recent History

Web 1.0 to Web 2.0 in simple terms — Web 1.0: Mostly a one-way read/write, centralized experience (1997-2007)

- A brand, person, company etc. builds a website, populates with content.
- People visit that website to read the content but have limited ways to interact, dialogue and generate unique content to share with the site owner and other visitors.
- Some interaction occurs through forums, message boards and email.
- In web 1.0, users would typically browse via a singular device, the PC.

[illegible]

A Review of Recent History, cont.

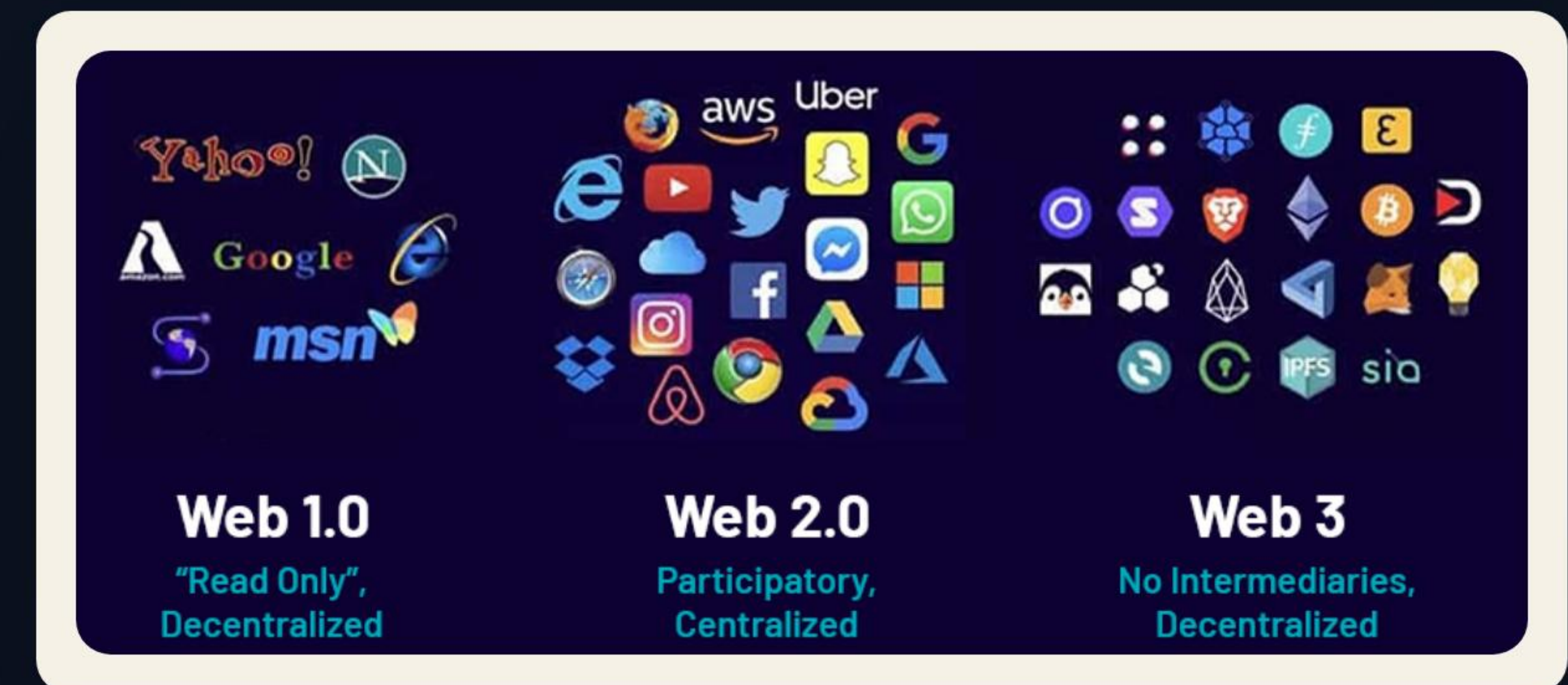
Web 1.0 to Web 2.0 in simple terms — Web 2.0: The participatory, conversational, social & decentralized web (2007-present)

- The new web empowers people to interact, generate, and share multi-media content across the web, seamlessly.
- The web has moved from a solo activity to a series of participatory activities enabled by new web applications, platforms, technologies and methodologies.
- Websites have become 2-way platforms and facilitators of people, content and conversations.
- In addition, these content platforms are accessible from multiple devices— the PC, mobile phones, netbooks, and gaming consoles.

A Review of Recent History, cont.

Web 3.0: Decentralized, open to everyone, and built on top of blockchain technologies

- The main distinctions between Web 2.0 and Web 3.0 involve data storage, connectivity, currency, and decentralization.
- Web 2.0 is about creating content and interacting with websites.
- Web 3.0 means immersing yourself in the digital experience, and it involves concepts like individual control of personal data, cryptocurrency, and decentralized record keeping on the blockchain.
- Web 3.0 relies on cryptocurrencies and a decentralized finance (DeFi) model. This is part of the decentralization objective, which shifts control from centralized companies or governments to users or the collective.
- The premise of decentralization extends beyond currency, covering everything from apps to data.



Popular Athletes on Social Media

- World Fame 100 (ESPN, 2019)
- How do you know you're famous? When everyone is talking about you, or in this day and age, looking you up on Google. For our fourth annual World Fame 100, we bring you each athlete's most searched moment worldwide, as measured by Google Trends. To identify the 100 most famous athletes in the world, we started with 800 of the biggest names in sports, drawn from 78 countries. We then ranked them based on a formula that took into account three fame factors:
- Search score
- Endorsement dollars
- Social media followers



Endorsements	Average
\$37m	12.6m
Search Score	Average
100	35
Social Following	Average
148m	10.6

Authentic... Is a Key

- Kobe Bryant took over the @NikeBasketball account for a day in December 2012 and alluded to using Twitter on his own.



Source – twitter.com/kobebryant/status/287245259572903937

Authentic... Is a Key, cont.



Kobe Bryant ✓
@kobebryant

 Follow

The antisocial has become social
[#mambatweets](#)

 Reply  Retweet  Favorite  More

51,451
RETWEETS

16,633
FAVORITES



9:13 AM - 4 Jan 13

Source – twitter.com/kobebryant/status/287245259572903937

Authentic... Is a Key, cont.

New Hampshire
Haverhill
Boston and Beyond
World/Nation
Business
Sports ▼
Video
ET TV
Taste of the Trib
Lifestyle
Opinion
Obituaries
Celebrations
Community Listings
Blogs
Hot Deals
Find a Business
Find a Home
Real Estate

Shaq turns into statue at Harvard Sq.

CAMBRIDGE (AP) — It started with a simple tweet.

Boston Celtics big man Shaquille O'Neal sent a tweet to followers yesterday afternoon that he was headed to Harvard Square to pose silently for photographs.

He had promised the stunt two weeks ago on Boston sports radio station 98.5 FM without specifying a time.

For more than an hour, the 38-year-old NBA veteran posed as a statue while dozens of curious onlookers took pictures of him just off the campus of Harvard University.

Shaq said nothing, but witnesses say he did smile at some fans' comments.

Afterward, Shaq tweeted a "thank you" to those who showed up.

O'Neal and the Celtics open the season Tuesday in Boston against LeBron James and the Miami Heat.



BEFORE AFTER

Emily got results with Proactiv®

proactiv. GET IT NOW

*Individual results may vary



Boston Celtics center Shaquille O'Neal, center, poses as a statue in Harvard Square in Cambridge, Mass., Thursday, Oct. 21, 2010. O'Neal sent a Twitter tweet to followers, then arrived and posed in silence for more than an hour just off the campus of Harvard University. (AP Photo/The Boston Globe, Yoon S. Byun) ** MANDATORY CREDIT. NO INTERNET USE. MAGS OUT. BOSTON OUT.

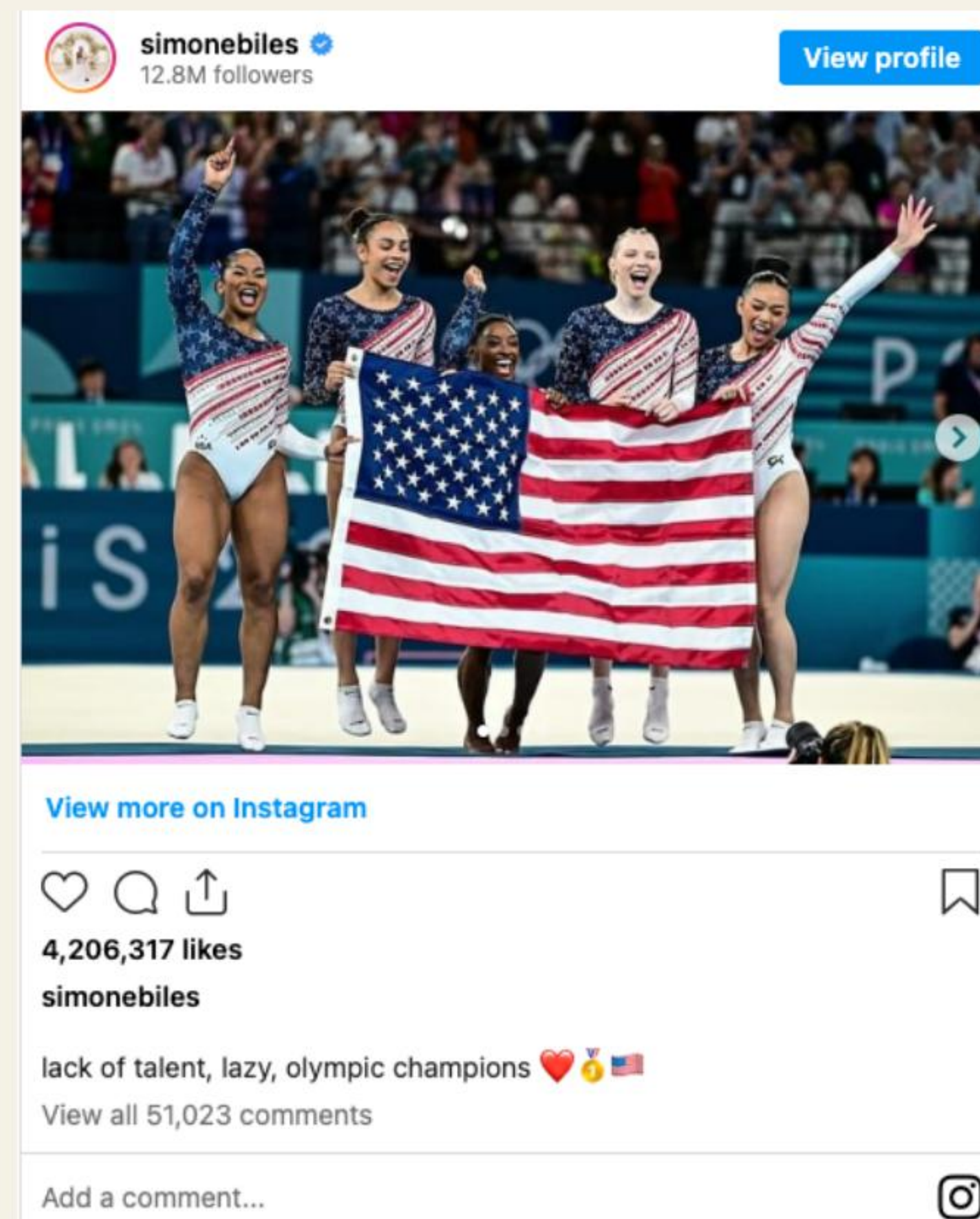
Transparency

- Kim Clijsters about her stunning loss 6-0, 6-1 against Nadia Petrova at 2010 Australian Open.



Transparency, cont.

- The caption appears to be a not-so-thinly-veiled shot at 2020 Olympic teammate MyKayla Skinner. “Besides Simone, I feel like the talent and the depth just isn’t like what it used to be” and “the girls just don’t have the work ethic.”



Charity Auctions

The screenshot shows the Twitter profile of TwitChange (@TwitChange). The profile header includes the TwitChange logo (an orange speech bubble), the name "TwitChange", the handle "@TwitChange", and the bio "Worldwide! We bring celebrities and fans together on Twitter for online charity auctions that CHANGE THE WORLD! http://TwitChange.com". Below the header is a "Following" button and icons for notifications, retweets, and settings. The main content area is titled "Timeline" and shows four tweets. The first tweet is from TwitChange to @simonereyes, saying "Thank you for joining us!!" (8 minutes ago). The second tweet is a retweet by TwitChange of a tweet from @simonereyes saying "I'm there 4 the troops! RT @TwitChange: Curious, who did YOU bid on today at http://TwitChange.com?" (16 minutes ago). The third tweet is from TwitChange to @LASportsGirl, saying "Thanks for all your support!" (9 minutes ago). The fourth tweet is from TwitChange to @hollvheartsnick, saying "Thanks friend!". On the right sidebar, the "About @TwitChange" section shows statistics: 4,421 Tweets, 22,312 Following, 27,467 Followers, and 606 Listed. Below this is the "Connections" section, showing "Followed by @THE_REAL_SHAQ." and "You both follow @steelers, @THE_REAL_SHAQ." with profile pictures. The "Following 22,312" section shows a row of profile pictures. At the bottom of the sidebar are links for "About", "Help", "Blog", "Status", "Jobs", "Terms", "Privacy", "Advertisers", "Businesses", "Media", "Developers", and "Res".

TwitChange
@TwitChange Worldwide!
We bring celebrities and fans together on Twitter for online charity auctions that CHANGE THE WORLD!
<http://TwitChange.com>

✓ Following

Timeline Favorites Following Followers Lists

TwitChange TwitChange
@simonereyes Thank you for joining us!!
8 minutes ago

simonereyes Simone Reyes by TwitChange
I'm there 4 the troops! RT @TwitChange: Curious, who did YOU bid on today at <http://TwitChange.com>?
16 minutes ago

TwitChange TwitChange
@LASportsGirl Thanks for all your support!
9 minutes ago

TwitChange TwitChange
@hollvheartsnick Thanks friend!

About @TwitChange

4,421 Tweets 22,312 Following 27,467 Followers 606 Listed

Connections

Followed by @THE_REAL_SHAQ.

You both follow @steelers, @THE_REAL_SHAQ.

Following 22,312

About · Help · Blog · Status · Jobs · Terms · Privacy · Advertisers · Businesses · Media · Developers · Res

Charity Auctions, cont.

Hi, kimjunwoo27! (Not you?)

CATEGORIES FASHION MOTORS DEALS CLASSIFIEDS

[Back to Search Results](#) | Listed in category: [Tickets > Experiences](#)



FREE shipping

TWITCHANGE Troy Polamalu MEGA @tpolamalu
Proceeds benefit Operation Once in a Lifetime

Item condition: --

Time left: 4d 03h (Feb 03, 2011 09:00:31 PST)

Bid history: 58 bids

Current bid: **US \$7,100.00**

Your max bid: US \$ **Place bid**
(Enter US \$7,200.00 or more)

Add to Watch list

Shipping: **FREE** Standard Shipping | [See all details](#)

Delivery: Estimated between **Mon. Feb. 28** and **Fri. Mar. 4** ⓘ

Returns: 7 day money back, buyer pays return shipping | [Read details](#)

Zoom unavailable Enlarge

Athletes for Purpose

- At the beginning of 2023, Instagram partnered with three of the UK's most exciting athletes. The goal? To shine a light on the causes that mattered the most to them. Together with Jack Grealish, Emma Raducanu and George Russell we co-produced Reels content throughout the year, giving them a platform to amplify the causes that they hold close to their hearts and share their own personal experiences. Their chosen advocacies? For Jack it was child disability, for George it was exploring the topic of mental health awareness and for Emma it was the importance of young children staying active in sports



Source – creators.instagram.com/blog/athletes-for-purpose?locale=en_US

Steven Jackson

- Fulfillment of Fans' curiosity



2004-2012

Steven Jackson, cont.

- "With the media and the Internet, we don't have to allow for other media outlets to outline who we are as a person as an athlete"
- He decided to commission a documentary to give the fans a clearer sense of what players go through.
- <http://www.sj39.com/film-video/>



The image is a screenshot of a video player interface. At the top, there's a progress bar showing 00:00 / 10:46. Below the progress bar, there are social media sharing options: a 'Tweet' button with 365 tweets and a Facebook 'Like' button with 830 likes. The main title 'A WEEK IN THE LIFE WITH STEVEN JACKSON' is prominently displayed in large, bold, white and yellow letters. To the right of the title is a small image of Steven Jackson in a white St. Louis Rams jersey with the number 39. Below the title, there's a paragraph of text: 'Sundays are the mileposts of the NFL calendar, but the days between them mark the season's arduous journey. That is the premise of "A Week in the Life With Steven Jackson," a three-part web series that spends one week -- all access -- with NFL Pro Bowl running back Steven Jackson and the St. Louis Rams.' Below this paragraph is a bulleted list of episode details: 'Episode I, "Recovery," debuted December 31, 2010.', 'Episode II, "Reunion," debuted January 1, 2011.', and 'Episode III, "Gameday," debuted January 2, 2011.' At the bottom, there's a section titled 'FOLLOW STEVEN ON:' with links to his Twitter (@sj39) and Facebook (facebook.com/stevenjackson39) profiles. To the right of this is a large 'SJ39' logo with the text 'THE OFFICIAL WEBSITE OF STEVEN JACKSON' underneath it.

00:00 / 10:46

Tweet 365 Cool S.Jun and 830 others like this Unlike

EPISODE 1: RECOVERY EPISODE 2: REUNION EPISODE 3: GAMEDAY

A WEEK IN THE LIFE WITH STEVEN JACKSON

Sundays are the mileposts of the NFL calendar, but the days between them mark the season's arduous journey. That is the premise of "A Week in the Life With Steven Jackson," a three-part web series that spends one week -- all access -- with NFL Pro Bowl running back Steven Jackson and the St. Louis Rams.

- Episode I, "Recovery," debuted December 31, 2010.
- Episode II, "Reunion," debuted January 1, 2011.
- Episode III, "Gameday," debuted January 2, 2011.

"A Week in the Life With Steven Jackson" is a co-production of Shock N Awe and Athlete Interactive, the premier digital branding agency for professional sports.

FOLLOW STEVEN ON:

twitter.com/sj39 facebook.com/stevenjackson39

CONTINUE TO: **SJ39**

THE OFFICIAL WEBSITE OF STEVEN JACKSON

Source – online.wsj.com/video/the-hardest-working-running-back/ED16AF7B-FC1B-438F-B294-B7AE800010D8.html

Justin Thomas

- PGA TOUR Originals: JT Unlocked presented by WHOOP offers unique insight from 14-time PGA TOUR champion Justin Thomas about his preparation to become his best possible self on and off the golf course, along with access to his life at home as he relaxes and unwinds from the various demands of life on TOUR.
- Watch Video Clip (below):
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=s6J2yWxW9sM&t=1078s>



Social Media Is... / And Not...

SOCIAL MEDIA IS...	AND NOT...
TRANSPARENT	VEILED
INCLUSIVE	EXCLUSIVE
AUTHENTIC	CONTRIVED
VIBRANT	MONOTONE
PEOPLE-DRIVEN	BRAND-DRIVEN

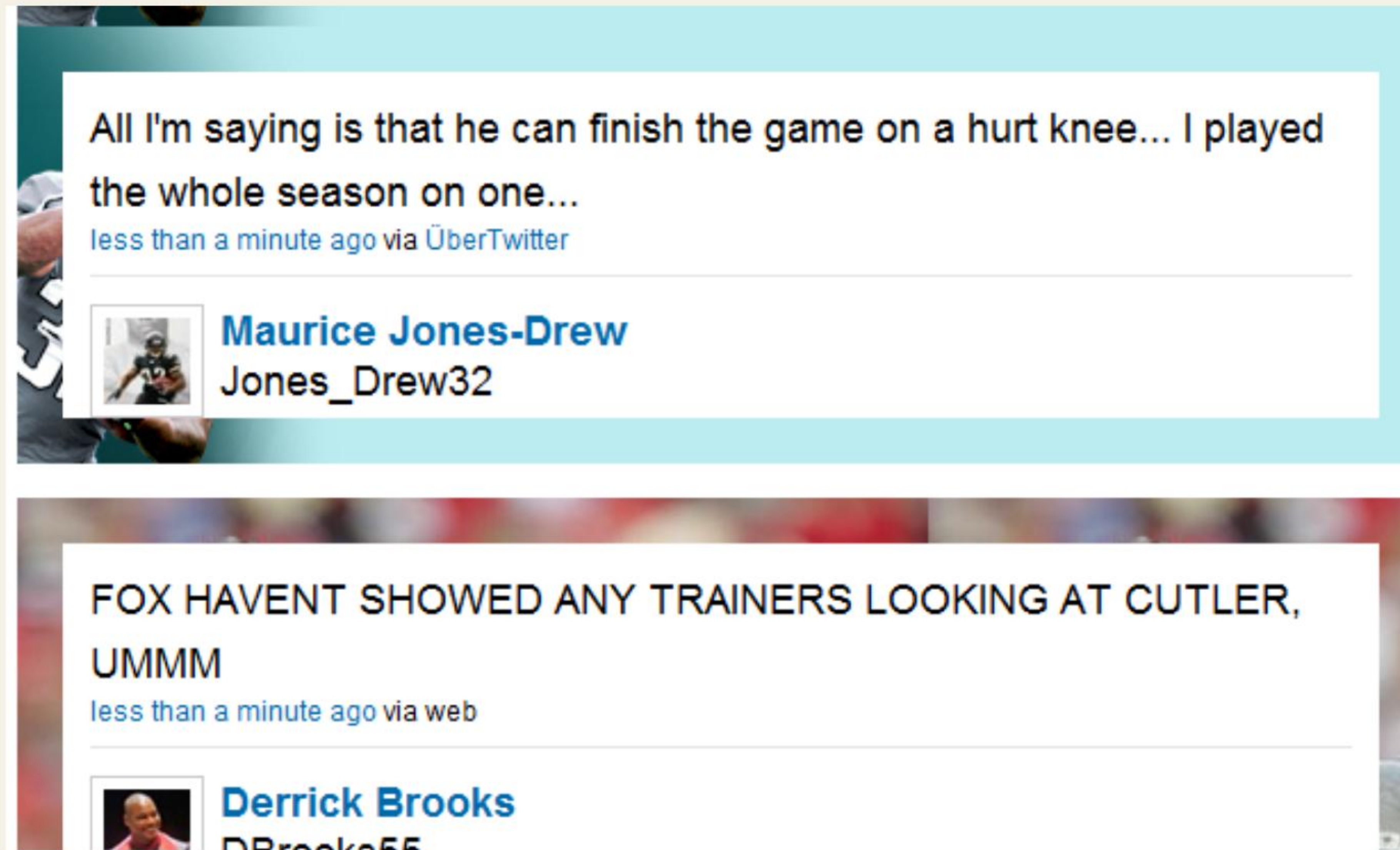
Social Media Attack Dooms Cutler

- Did Cutler quit? (2011 NFC championship)
- Watch video clip:
- http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=J2_NHfEuDZw



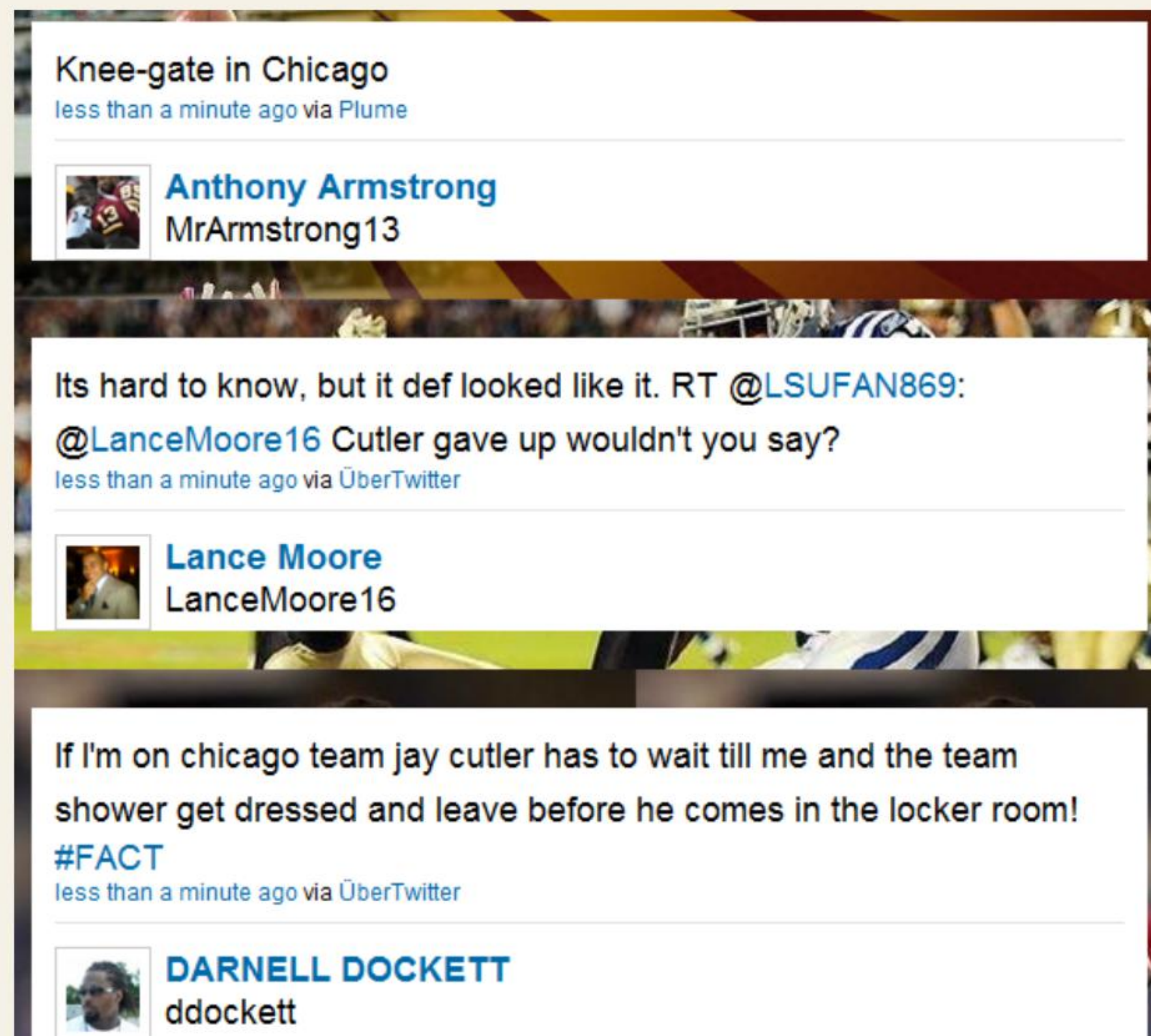
— THE NFL'S FIRST PLAYER-ON-PLAYER SOCIAL MEDIA ATTACK

Social Media Attack Dooms Cutler, cont.



Social Media Attack Dooms Cutler, cont.

- The NFL's first player-on-player social media attack



Player vs Fan

- Russell Westbrook Says Utah Jazz Fan Made 'Racial' Taunt That Led to Confrontation



Player vs Fan, cont.

- The confrontation between Westbrook and the Jazz fan
- https://twitter.com/E_Woodyard/status/1105326957191815168
- Watch video below:
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FCmjUyZBmcw>



Eric Woodyard ✓ @E_Woodyard · Mar 11, 2019

Things get heated between Russell Westbrook and Utah Jazz fans again. "I'll f*ck you up. You and your wife," he says. Not sure what these fans said to him, but he also had issues with Jazz fans during the postseason.



Eric Woodyard ✓ @E_Woodyard

Replying to @E_Woodyard

Russell Westbrook says the fan and his wife told him to "to get down on your knees like you're used to" which is why he responded. "As for beating up his wife, I've never put my hand on a woman. I never will. Never been in any domestic violence before and never have," he said.



Player vs Fan, cont.

- Jazz owner Gail Miller addresses crowd following Russell Westbrook incident
- The Fan named Shane Keisel was permanently banned from Utah Jazz in 2019
- The NBA announced that it had fined Westbrook \$25,000 “for directing profanity and threatening language to a fan.”
- <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=IWEUqog3F60>



Source – [nytimes.com/2019/03/12/sports/russell-westbrook-utah-fan.html](https://www.nytimes.com/2019/03/12/sports/russell-westbrook-utah-fan.html)

- Fans are able to 'scrap and share' exclusive content with their social networks contributing to the team, league and athlete's 'accumulated influence' beyond traditional media platforms.

Source – slideshare.net/marobella/social-media-in-sports-the-athlete-1151579

- "Twitter is a waste of time", says Manchester United manager Sir Alex Ferguson.

